

Bartar English

Designing a language school's first mobile app — 2016.

In 2016, Bartar Language School wanted to give its students a way to keep learning between classes. I joined as the app's interface was taking shape and collaborated on its design — the screens, the navigation, and the visual language of a simple, friendly Android app. It was built in the flat Material Design style of the time, with no AI and a deliberately small, focused set of features: sign in, follow a course, do a lesson, learn words, and check your class schedule.

AUTHOR

Samaneh Shirinnezhad

YEAR

2016-2017

ROLE

UI design collaborator

PLATFORM

Android · Material Design

SCOPE

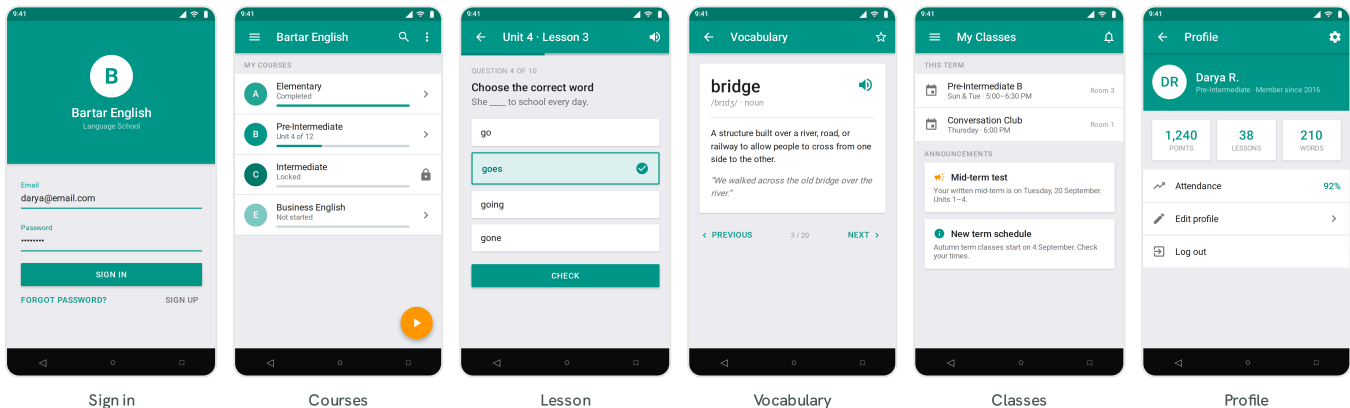
Onboarding, courses, lessons, vocabulary, class schedule, profile

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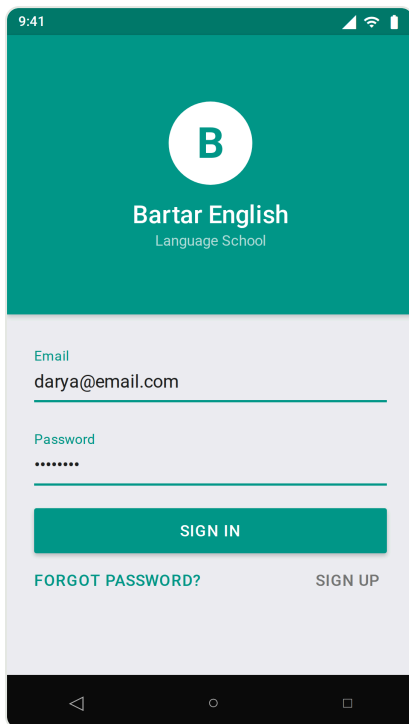
My role

- Collaborated on the app's interface — screen layouts, navigation, and visual style — as the product took shape.
 - Helped define the core UI patterns reused across the app: the app bar, course list, lesson exercises, and vocabulary cards.
- Brought a classroom teacher's perspective into design decisions, keeping screens simple and approachable for mixed ages and levels.
 - Worked within the constraints of the era — flat Material Design, Roboto, standard Android components, and no AI.

THE APP, SCREEN BY SCREEN



Screens reconstructed to represent the original 2016 release.



01 · SIGN IN

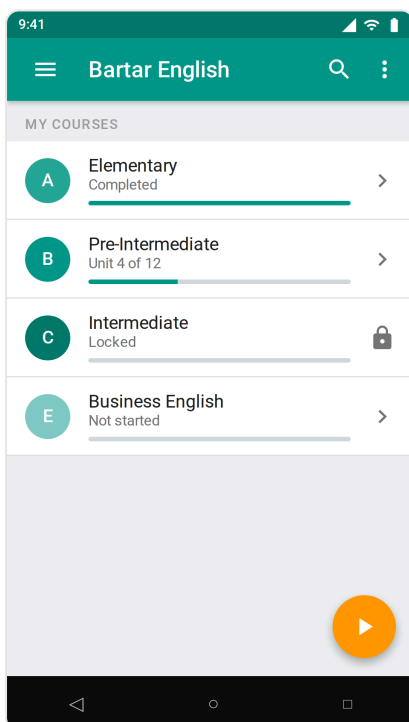
A fast way in

The entry point was a single screen: the school's mark, and a straightforward email-and-password sign-in. No social logins, no onboarding carousel — students were issued an account by the school, so the priority was simply getting them to their courses quickly.



MY PART

Set the visual identity on the very first screen — the logo lockup, the brand colour, and the Material text-field styling.



02 · MY COURSES

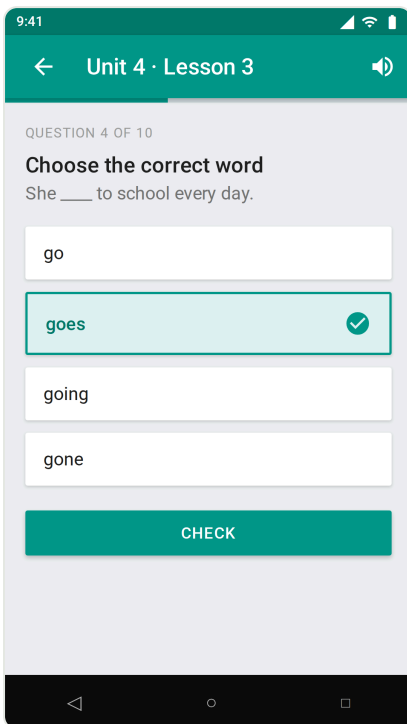
Always know where you are

The home screen listed the student's levels, from Elementary to Business English, each with a progress bar and a clear locked or unlocked state. On the small phones of the time, this gave learners an at-a-glance sense of how far they'd come and what came next.



MY PART

Helped shape the course-list pattern and the at-a-glance progress and status system, with a single primary action to resume learning.



03 · LESSON

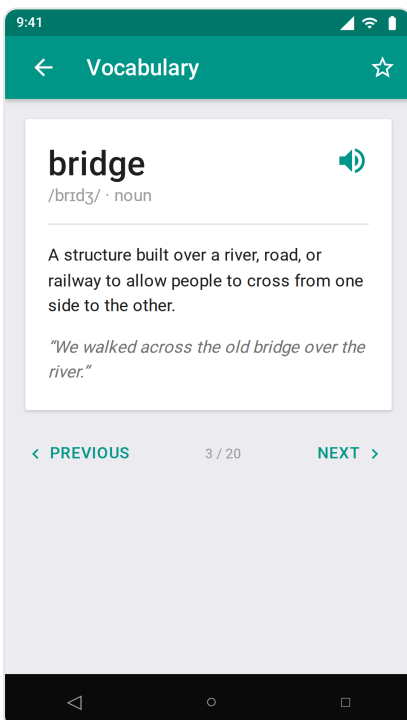
One question, one action

Lessons were built from simple, self-contained exercises — here, a multiple-choice grammar question with a progress indicator and a single clear button. Keeping each step to one question and one action kept cognitive load low and the app usable on modest hardware.



MY PART

Worked on the exercise layout and the selected-answer state, and the consistent rhythm used across every lesson.



04 · VOCABULARY

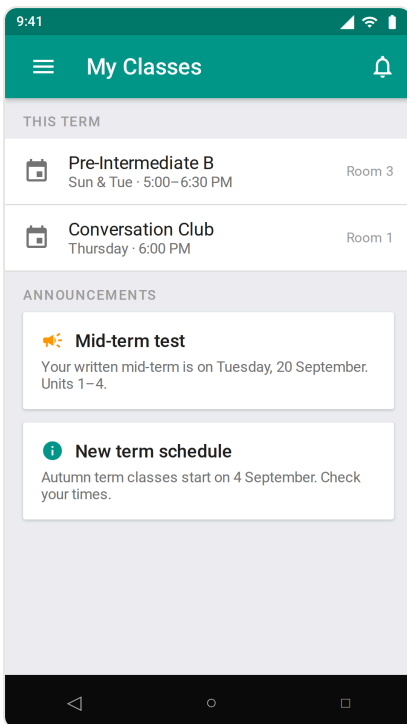
A word, four ways

The vocabulary view paired each word with its pronunciation, part of speech, a plain-language definition, and an example sentence — multimodal in spirit even in a pre-AI app, so a new word could be seen, heard, and understood in context.



MY PART

Contributed the word-card layout and the audio-and-example pattern that made new words easy to absorb and review.



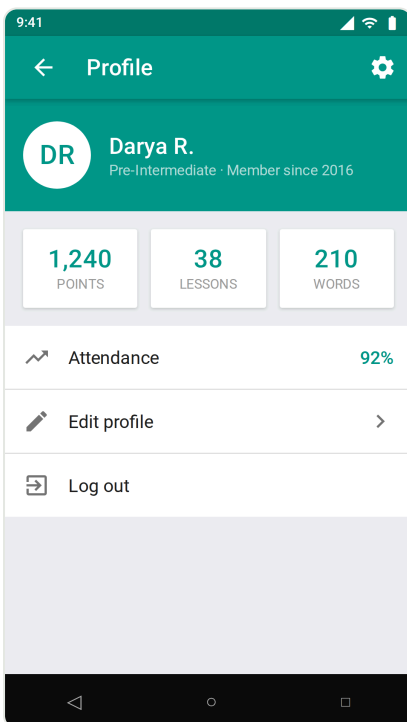
05 · MY CLASSES

Tied to the real classroom

Because Bartar is a physical school, the app also held the timetable — class days, times, and rooms — alongside announcements such as test dates. It was the link between the digital product and the school's day-to-day life, something a pure self-study app wouldn't have.

 MY PART

Worked on the schedule and announcements screens, bridging the app and the school's everyday operations.



06 · PROFILE

Encouraging, not pressuring

A simple profile summarised a student's progress — points, lessons, words learned, and attendance — without the streaks and gamification pressure that later apps leaned on. The tone was meant to reassure, not to chase.

 MY PART

Worked on the profile header and the at-a-glance stats layout, keeping the tone calm and low-pressure.

NINE YEARS ON

I returned to lead a full, human-centered redesign of this app — see the companion case study.